

Analytic Method

It proceeds from unknown to known. 'Analysis' means 'breaking up' of the problem in hand so that it ultimately gets connected with something obvious or already known. It is the process of unfolding of the problem or of conducting its operation to know its hidden aspects. Start with what is to be found out. Then think of further steps and possibilities which may connect the unknown with the known and find out the desired result. In its original sense the verb "to analyse" means to loosen or separate things that are together. About analysis, Thorndike says that all the highest intellectual performance of the mind is analysis.

Merits of the Analytic Method

1. It is logical method. It leaves to doubts and convinces the learner.
2. It facilitates understanding. It also strengthens the urge to discover facts
3. The steps in its procedure are developed in a general manner. No cramming of a fixed step and a set pattern is necessitated. Each step has its reason and justification.
4. The student is throughout faced with such questions as "How to prove the equality of two angles?" "What are the possible ways of resolving a statement into simpler elements etc.?" Thus the student grapples with the problem confidently and intelligently. He gains in comprehension and skill.

Drawbacks

1. It is a lengthy method.
2. With this method. it is difficult to acquire efficiency and speed.
3. It may not be applicable to all topics equally well.